

AtomoxApex

10 mg, 18 mg, 25 mg, 40 mg, 60 mg capsules

COMPOSITION:

Each AtomoxApex 10 mg capsule contains: 10 mg atomoxetine.
Each AtomoxApex 18 mg capsule contains: 18 mg atomoxetine.
Each AtomoxApex 25 mg capsule contains: 25 mg atomoxetine.
Each AtomoxApex 40 mg capsule contains: 40 mg atomoxetine.
Each AtomoxApex 60 mg capsule contains: 60 mg atomoxetine.

CLINICAL PHARMACOLOGY:

Mechanism of Action: The precise mechanism by which Atomoxetine produces its therapeutic effects in attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD) is unknown, but is thought to be related to selective inhibition of the pre-synaptic norepinephrine transporter, as determined in ex vivo uptake and neurotransmitter depletion studies.

Pharmacokinetics: Atomoxetine is rapidly absorbed after oral administration, with absolute bioavailability of about 63% in extensive metabolizers (EMs) and 94% in poor metabolizers (PMs). Maximal plasma concentrations (C_{max}) are reached approximately 1 to 2 hours after dosing. AtomoxApex can be administered with or without food. Atomoxetine is metabolized primarily through the CYP2D6 enzymatic pathway.

INDICATIONS:

AtomoxApex is indicated for the treatment of attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD).

WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS:

• Suicidal ideation in children and adolescents:

Atomoxetine increased the risk of suicidal ideation in short-term studies in children or adolescents with attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD). Anyone considering the use of atomoxetine in a child or adolescent must balance this risk with the clinical need. Co-morbidities occurring with ADHD may be associated with an increase in the risk of suicidal ideation and/or behavior. Patients who are started on therapy should be monitored closely for suicidality (suicidal thinking and behavior), clinical worsening, or unusual changes in behavior. Families and caregivers should be advised of the need for close observation and communication with the prescriber. Atomoxetine is approved for ADHD in pediatric and adult patients. Atomoxetine is not approved for major depressive disorder.

• Atomoxetine is contraindicated in patients with symptomatic cardiovascular diseases, moderate to severe hypertension or severe cardiovascular disorders whose condition would be expected to deteriorate if they experienced increase in blood pressure or in heart rate that could be clinically important.

• Atomoxetine should be used with caution in patients whose underlying medical conditions could be worsened by increase in blood pressure or heart rate, such as patients with hypertension, tachycardia, cardiovascular or cerebrovascular disease.

• Atomoxetine should be used with caution in patients with congenital or acquired long QT syndrome or a family history of QT prolongation.

• Patients should be screened for pre-existing or underlying cardiovascular or cerebrovascular conditions before initiation of treatment with atomoxetine and monitored during the course of treatment.

• It is recommended that heart rate and blood pressure be measured in all patients before treatment with atomoxetine is started after the dose is increased, and periodically during treatment to detect possible clinically important increases, particularly during the first few months of therapy.

- Suicidal Ideation – Monitor for suicidality, clinical worsening, and unusual changes in behavior.
- Severe Liver Injury – Should be discontinued and not restarted in patients with jaundice or laboratory evidence of liver injury.
- Patients should have a careful history and physical exam to assess for presence of cardiovascular disease. Atomoxetine generally should not be used in children or adolescents with known serious structural cardiac abnormalities, cardiomyopathy, serious heart rhythm abnormalities, or other serious cardiac problems that may place them at increased vulnerability to its noradrenergic effects. Consideration should be given to not using atomoxetine in adults with clinically significant cardiac abnormalities.
- Use with caution in patients with hypertension, tachycardia, or cardiovascular or cerebrovascular disease.
- Aggressive behavior or hostility should be monitored.
- Possible allergic reactions, including angioneurotic edema, urticaria, and rash.
- Urinary hesitancy and retention may occur.
- Concomitant use of potent CYP2D6 Inhibitors or use in patients known to be CYP2D6 PMs – Dose adjustment of atomoxetine may be necessary.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION:

Pregnant or nursing women should not use unless potential benefit justifies potential risk to fetus or infant.

DRUG INTERACTIONS:

- Monoamine Oxidase Inhibitors.
- CYP2D6 Inhibitors - Concomitant use may increase atomoxetine steady-state plasma concentrations in EMs.
- Pressor Agents - Possible effects on blood pressure, atomoxetine should be used cautiously with pressor agents (e.g., dopamine, dobutamine).
- Atomoxetine should be administered with caution to patients being treated with systemically-administered (oral or intravenous) albuterol (or other beta2 agonists) because the action of albuterol on the cardiovascular system can be potentiated resulting in increases in heart rate and blood pressure.

CONTRAINDICATIONS:

- Hypersensitivity to atomoxetine or other constituents of product.
- Atomoxetine use within 2 weeks after discontinuing MAOI or other drugs that affect brain monoamine concentrations.
- Narrow Angle Glaucoma.

ADVERSE REACTIONS:

Nausea, vomiting, fatigue, decreased appetite, abdominal pain, and somnolence.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION:

Dosing for children and adolescents up to 70 kg body weight:

AtomoxApex should be initiated at a total daily dose of approximately 0.5 mg/kg and increased after a minimum of 3 days to a target total daily dose of approximately 1.2 mg/kg administered either as a single daily dose in the morning or as evenly divided doses in the morning and late afternoon/early evening.

Dosing for children and adolescents over 70 kg body weight and adults:

AtomoxApex should be initiated at a total daily dose of 40 mg and increased after a minimum of 3 days to a target total daily dose of approximately 80 mg administered either as a single daily dose in the morning or as evenly divided doses in the morning and late afternoon/early evening. After 2 to 4 additional weeks, the dose may be increased to a maximum of 100 mg in patients who have not achieved an optimal response.

General Dosing Information:

- AtomoxApex may be taken with or without food.
- AtomoxApex can be discontinued without being tapered.

Dosing in Specific Populations:

Dosing adjustment for hepatically impaired patients — for those ADHD patients who have hepatic insufficiency (HI), dosage adjustment is recommended as follows: For patients with moderate HI (Child-Pugh Class B), initial and target doses should be reduced to 50% of the normal dose (for patients without HI). For patients with severe HI (Child-Pugh Class C), initial dose and target doses should be reduced to 25% of normal.

PACKAGING AND STORAGE:

- AtomoxApex 10 mg capsules: Pack of 30 capsules.
 - AtomoxApex 18 mg capsules: Pack of 30 capsules.
 - AtomoxApex 25 mg capsules: Pack of 30 capsules.
 - AtomoxApex 40 mg capsules: Pack of 30 capsules.
 - AtomoxApex 60 mg capsules: Pack of 30 capsules.
- Store in a dry place at temperature below 25 °C.

Keep All Medicines Out of Reach of Children

Manufactured by: Apex Pharma - S.A.E - Badr City - Egypt.

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